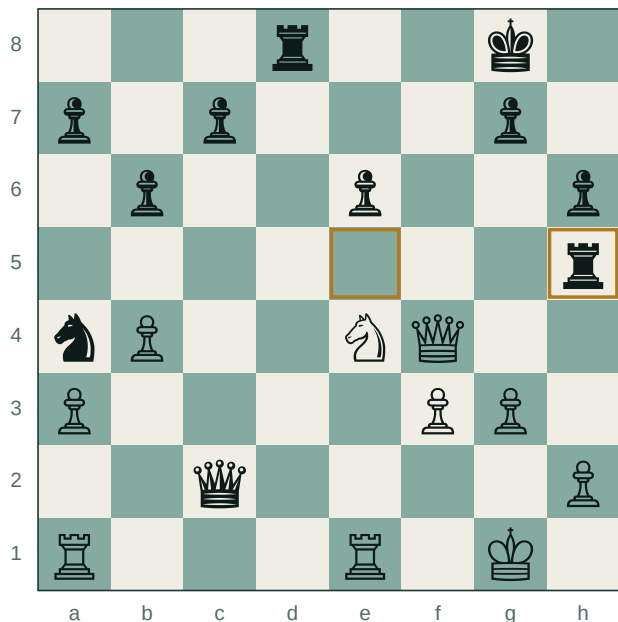


# Calculated sacrifices: White, move 26

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 25...Rh5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**26. Nf6+ gxf6 27. Qg4+ Kf7 28. Qxh5+**

**26.Nf6+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on g8 and rook on h5. Recorded reply: **26...gxf6**.

**27.Qg4+** Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From g4 it attacks king on g8 and rook on h5. Recorded reply: **27...Kf7**.

**28.Qxh5+** Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on h5.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8 and rook on h5. Check for tactical protection.